Lesson 1 · What is a sensor?

Sensor spotter

Find the parts that notice, show and act

Name _____
Class _____
Date _____

Work with a partner. Read each item and decide.

1 Sense or act? Tick one box: does it sense something, or act?

	Senses (sensor)	Acts (actuator)
a Thermometer on the classroom wall	☐	☐
b Pump that waters the garden	☐	☐
c Microphone in a phone	☐	☐
d Buzzer that sounds an alarm	☐	☐
e Light sensor in a solar lamp	☐	☐
f Motor that turns a fan	☐	☐
g Probe that checks soil moisture	☐	☐
h Loudspeaker playing music	☐	☐

2 What does it sense? Draw a line from each sensor to what it notices.

1 Thermometer ○	○ Sound
2 Soil probe ○	○ How bright or dark it is
3 Microphone ○	○ How hot or cold it is
4 Light sensor ○	○ How wet the soil is

3 My sensor Draw a sensor you have seen at home or school. Write what it senses.

Draw here

_____
_____
_____

Challenge

A school wants its garden watered only when the soil is dry. Name the sensor, the actuator, and who or what decides.

_____
_____